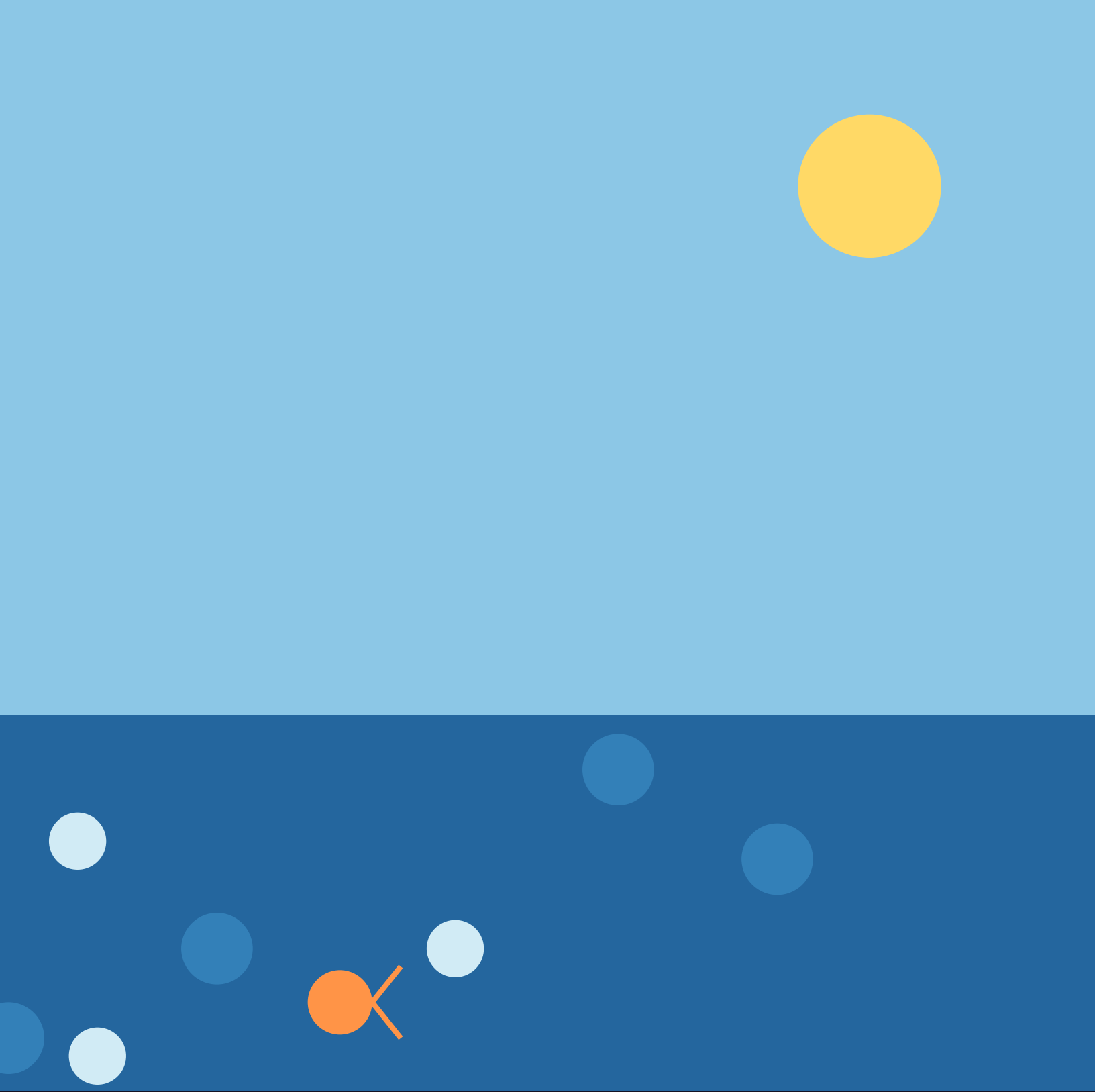


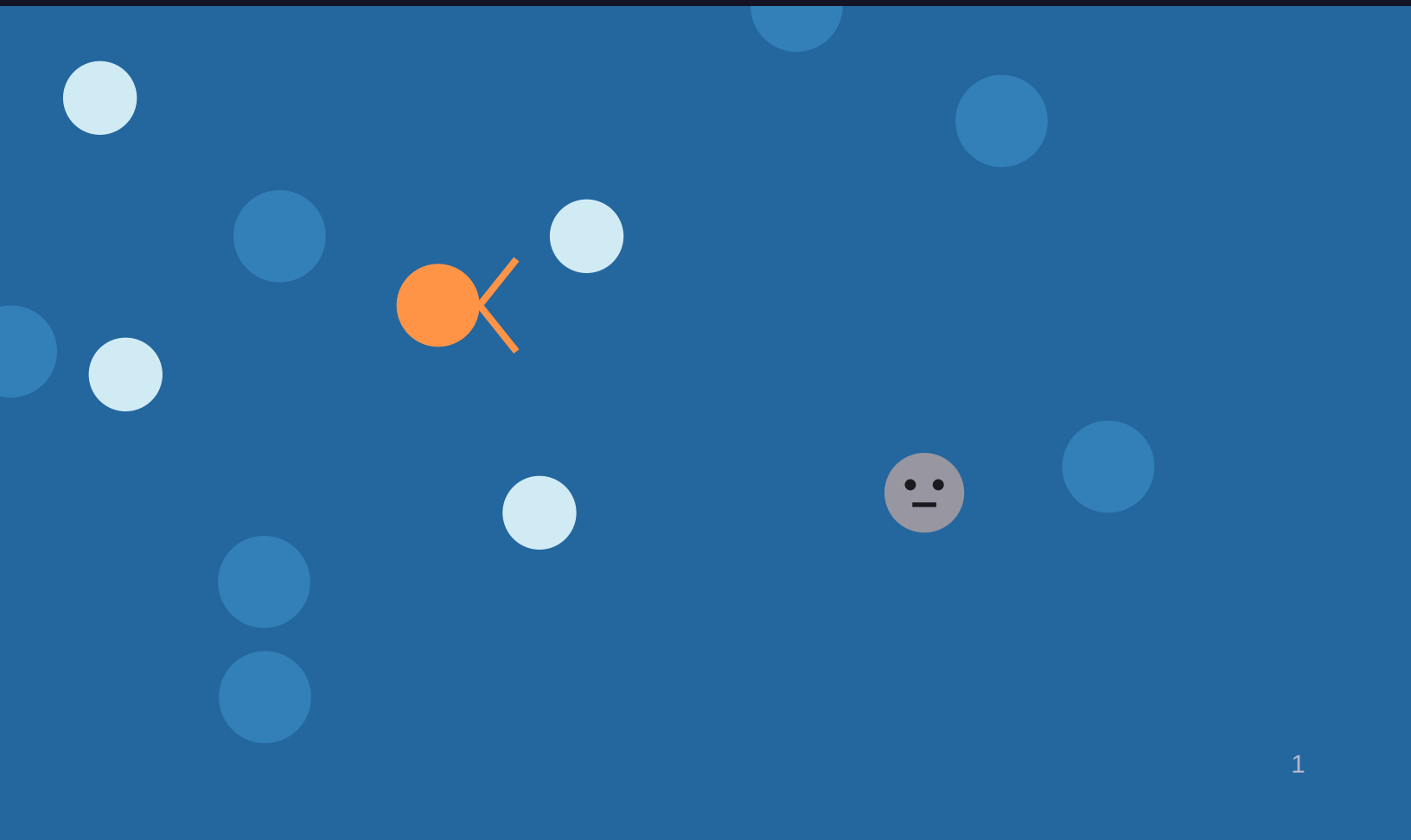


Gentle Outer Space Whale

picture by Echo

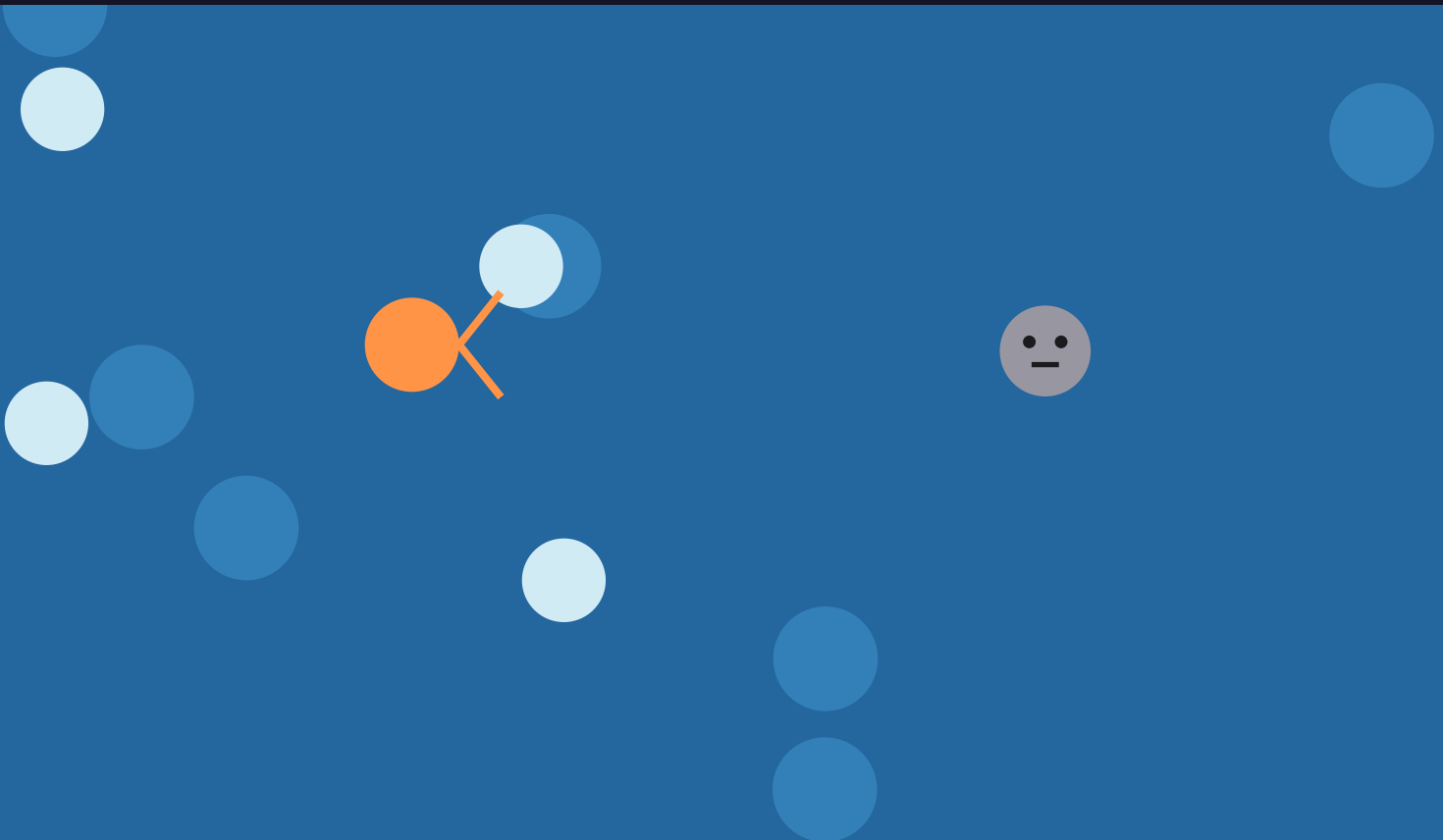


The gentle whale felt small compared to outer space -- the vastness made it wonder if its actions mattered at all.





**One day, when someone in that endless
expanse needed assistance, the little
whale's heart raced -- how could such a
small thing make a difference?**



A dark blue night sky with a large, bright yellow crescent moon in the upper right. Numerous small, white stars of varying sizes are scattered across the sky.

"Am I too small?" it questioned quietly.



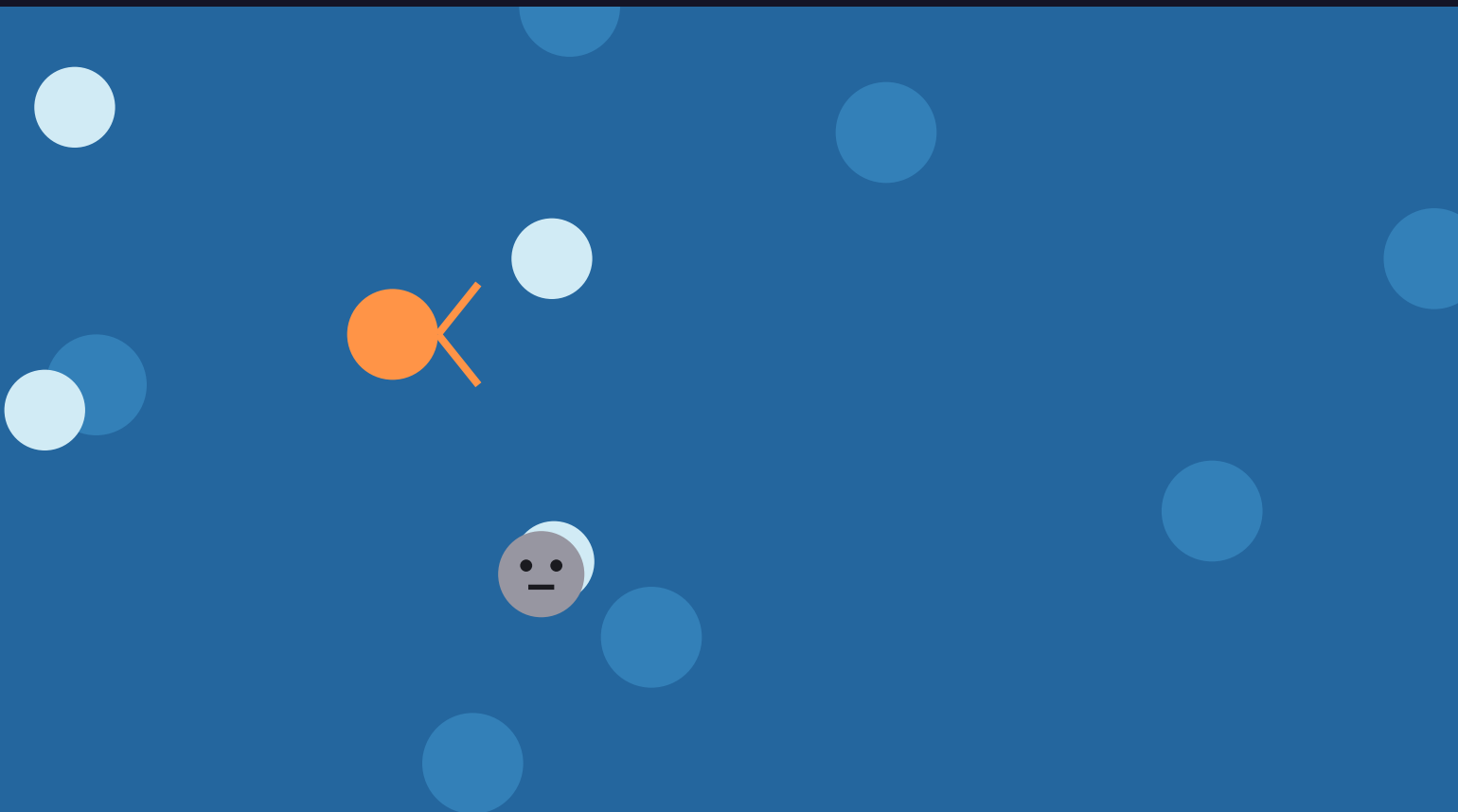


**The voice echoed through the void -- no
answer came from the silent night sky.**





But something stirred within the gentle whale as an idea took shape.





**It knew -- it just had to try, with all
its might and heart.**





**And so it did -- smaller than stars yet
strong beyond measure.**





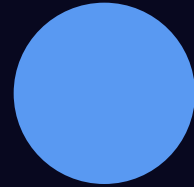
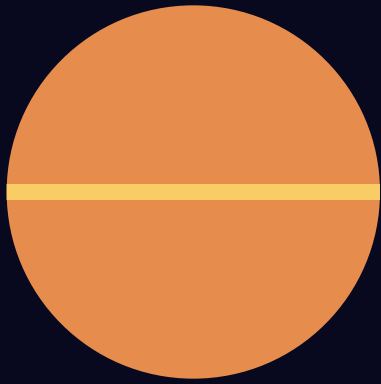
**Day after day passed by like sand falling
through a glass hourglass.**





The tiny creature's determination grew with every attempt, becoming a light that flickered across the dark expanse.





The End

asking for help is a kind of courage

